



January 16, 2025

J. Andrew Smith
jasmith52@wisc.edu

Dear J. Andrew:

The Department of Economics Teaching Assistant Review Committee has examined student and faculty evaluations of your teaching performance during the Fall 2024 semester. Your average score on the "rate performance" question (#6) was **4.67**. It is a pleasure to inform you that the excellence of your teaching during the semester warrants a citation as a "Distinguished Teaching Assistant." The Committee concluded that you were one of the truly outstanding TAs in the fall semester. Being a highly successful TA involves considerable effort and dedication. This level of achievement involved a considerable commitment on your part. You have made a substantial contribution to the quality of our teaching program. We extend our congratulations and believe that your performance augurs well for your future, especially in the classroom.

The Committee thought it might be helpful for each TA to have the following information:

Fall 2024 Question (#6) Frequency Distribution of Average Scores on "Rate Performance"	
Score Range	Number TAs Receiving this Score
4.67 - 5.00 (Distinguished)	17
4.38 - 4.68 (Excellent)	25
3.70 - 4.37 (Good)	33
3.00 - 3.69 (Satisfactory)	9
Below 3.0	1

Average TA rating on this question was 4.25

Copies of this letter, the faculty evaluation, and student evaluation summary will be included in your file.

Sincerely yours,

Ananth Seshadri
Professor, Mary Sue & Mike Shannon Distinguished Chair
Chair, TA Review Committee

Fall 2024 End of Term TA Eval Completed

2024 Fall / Student Course Evaluation (End of Term) / Anonymous Survey

Course Assignments: 230 / Survey Participants: 4810

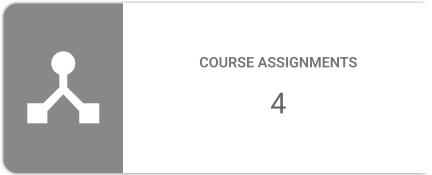
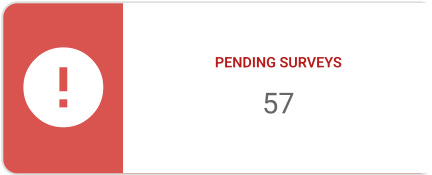
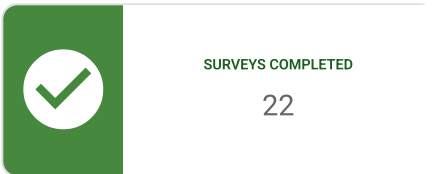
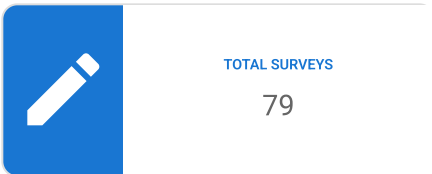
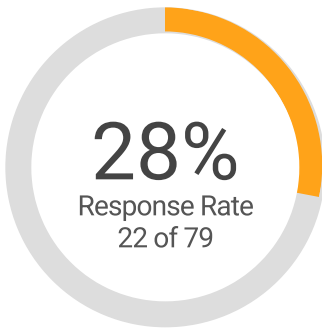
Schedule: 11/27/2024 to 12/11/2024

Results Available: 12/27/2024

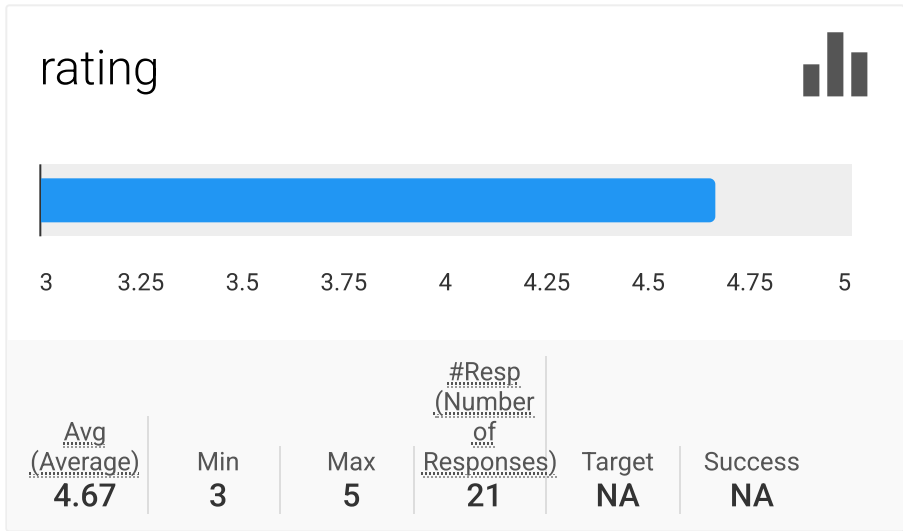
 This survey completed on **Wednesday, December 11, 2024 at 11:59PM.**

Instructor:  Andrew Smith

 Survey Overview : Instructor Results Aggregate



 Survey Metrics : Instructor Results Aggregate



 Survey Data : Instructor Results Aggregate

Section 1

DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS TA EVALUATION

I-Teaching Assistant

1

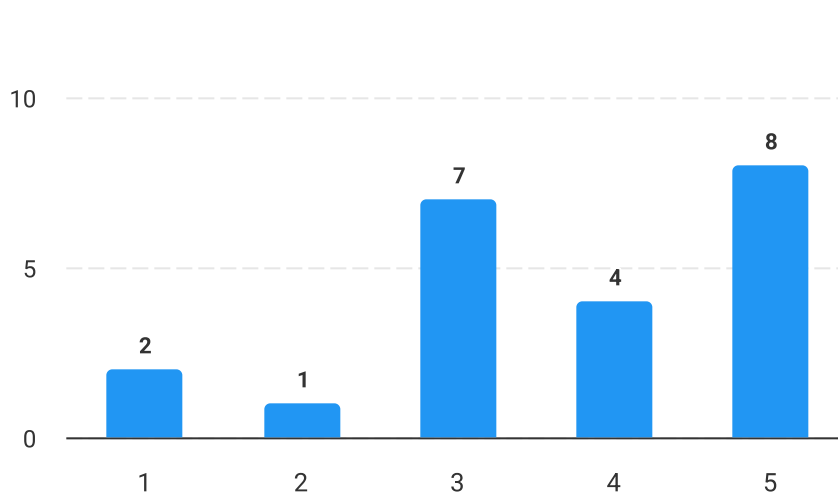
How many of the discussion or lab sections led by the TA have you attended so far?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
1	None	2
2	One	1
3	Two - Five	7
4	Six - Ten	4
5	11 or more	8



Average

3.68

Median

4.00

Mode

5

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

1.26

Variance

1.58

2

How would you rate the TA's ability to lead discussion or present material in your section?

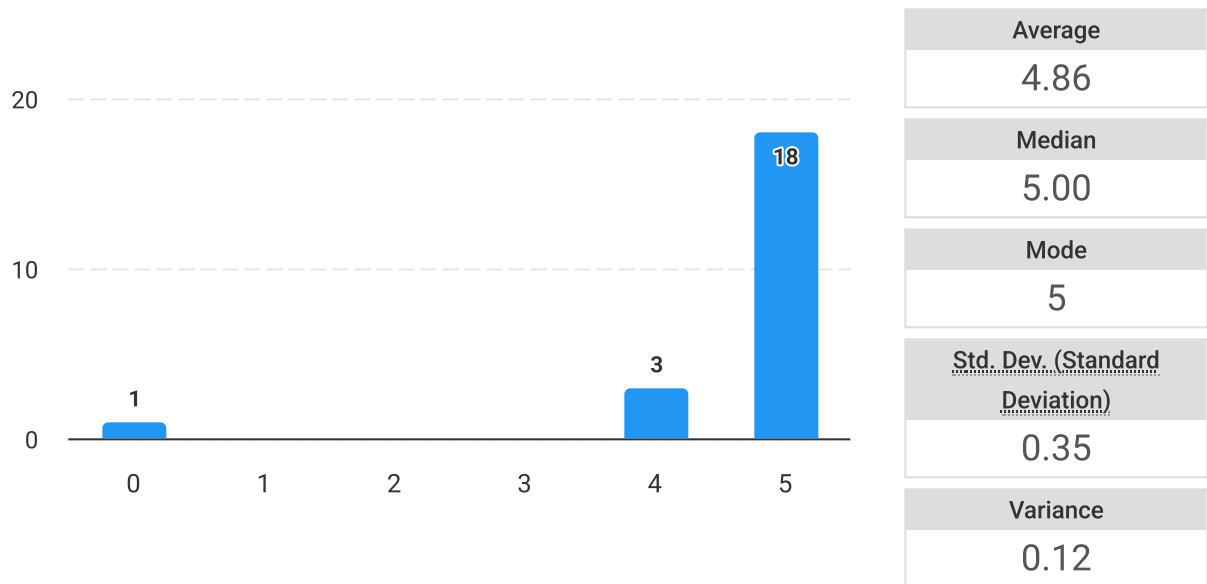
(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
-	Did not attend	1
1	Poor	0

Value	Option	Total
2	Fair	0
3	Average	0
4	Good	3
5	Excellent	18



3

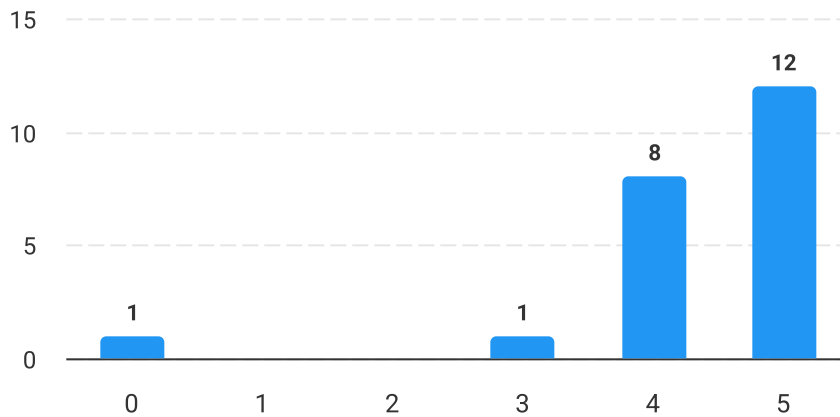
Of those sections you have attended, what proportion were interesting and/or thought-provoking?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
-	Did not attend	1
1	Almost none	0
2	Few	0
3	About Half	1
4	Most	8
5	Almost all	12



Average
4.52
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.59
Variance
0.34

4

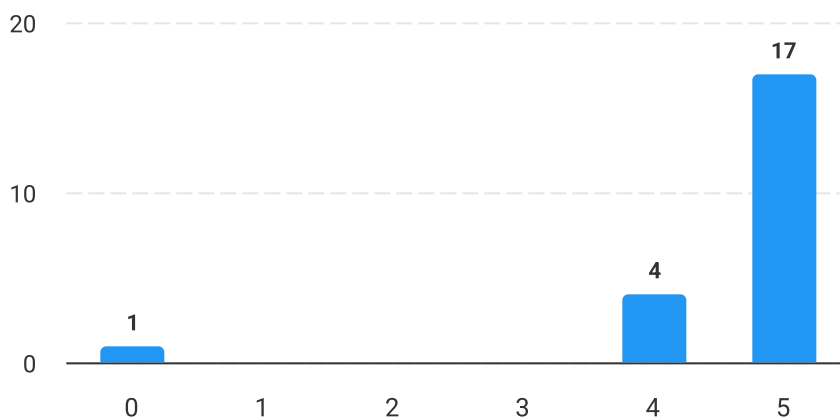
Overall, what is your assessment of the TA's knowledge of the material related to this course?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
-	Did not attend	1
1	Poor	0
2	Fair	0
3	Average	0
4	Good	4
5	Excellent	17



Average
4.81
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.39
Variance
0.15

5

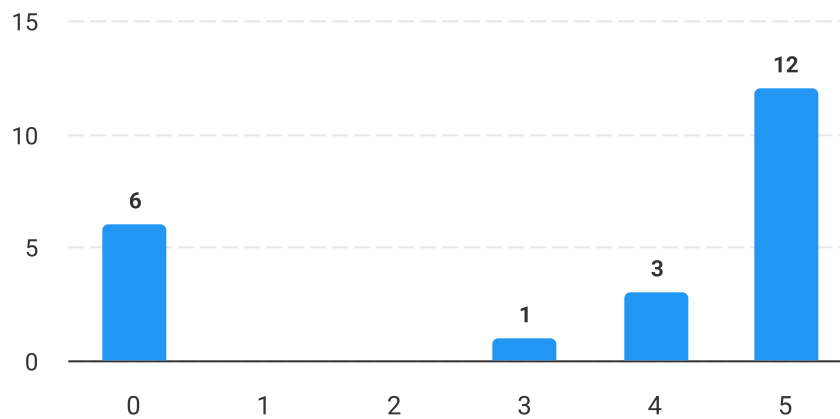
How responsive and helpful did you find your TA during office hours?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
-	Did not attend	6
1	Not at all helpful	0
2	Slightly helpful	0
3	Of average helpfulness	1
4	Better than average helpfulness	3
5	Extremely helpful	12



Average

4.69

Median

5.00

Mode

5

Std. Dev. (Standard
Deviation)

0.58

Variance

0.34

6

We know that how the professor conducts the course often influences what a TA is able to do in a course. Given the professor's role and the structure of this course, how would you evaluate your TA's performance?

(Instructor Multi-Choice)

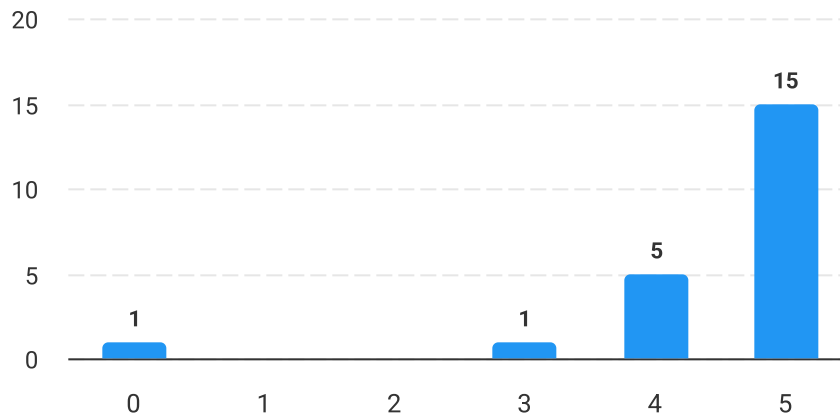


rating



Andrew, Smith Instructor

Value	Option	Total
-	No Answer	1
1	Poor	0
2	Fair	0
3	Average	1
4	Good	5
5	Excellent	15



Average
4.67
Median
5.00
Mode
5
Std. Dev. (Standard Deviation)
0.56
Variance
0.32

II-TA Open-ended Questions

7

Please comment on any aspects of the section which you consider particularly satisfactory or unsatisfactory. Since this information will be given to the TA for improvement in his or her teaching, be as specific as you can in discussing and evaluating any phase of the section: presentation, responsiveness to questions, command of material, organization, mannerisms, teaching aids, etc.

(Instructor Text/Memo)



Andrew, Smith Instructor

- He is really good at explaining the contents in very simple manner, breaking down the difficult ones. Overall, I learnt more from the TA than the professor.
- i liked how we went over every problem and he described all the concepts before going into the problems itself.
- Probably didn't attend section enough to give credible feedback.
- Overall he did a very good job of clarifying the material we learned in lecture. Just very good at his job in every aspect.
- Good
- Only attended two discussions so can't say much but I found the TA to be straightforward and to explain concepts in an easy to understand way.
- I particularly found that when the TA goes through and reviews the topics during the week's lecture before working on the worksheet very satisfactory.
- Andrew clearly reviewed content from lecture at the beginning of discussion, then walked the class through each example, including steps on how to solve each problem. Discussion was super helpful in solidifying my understanding of the content. Andrew was very timely when replying to emails. Overall a great TA, would highly recommend class to others!
- Andrew is the goat, best TA I have had at UW Madison.
- Andrew is one of the best TA's I have had at UW-Madison. His reviews of the content in discussion are concise and totally worth students' time. He effectively guides students through practice problems, holds useful exam review sessions, and answers questions thoroughly. Kudos to Andrew for making Econ 301 an easy class to be successful in!
- Your discussions were so helpful !! They were optional but I almost always went because you helped us work through difficult problems, reviewed/summarized important parts of lectures, and explained everything so

clearly.

- Discussions help with me a lot.

lecture problems before every difficult
went problem concepts through overall
job discussions found easy reviews each helpful had good

8

What, if anything, limited your participation in section? (TA's style, other students, course structure, time of section, lack of preparation, etc.)

(Text/Memo)

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